LACEMENT PREPARATIO

Verbal Ability & Grammar Master Guide

Grammar Foundations: Subject-Verb Agreement & Error Spotting

1. Rules of Subject-Verb Agreement

- Rule: Two singular subjects joined by 'and' require a plural verb (e.g. 'Rahul and Aman are best friends').
- Rule: Phrases like 'as well as', 'along with', 'accompanied by' do NOT compound subjects (e.g. 'The teacher, along with the students, is present').
- Rule: 'Neither... nor' and 'Either... or' take the verb agreeing with the closest subject (e.g. 'Neither the principal nor the teachers were willing to alter the schedule').
- Rule: Collective nouns take singular verbs when acting as a unified entity (e.g. 'The committee has submitted its report').

2. High-Yield Error Spotting Rules

- Inversion after negative adverbs: 'Under no circumstances should employees disclose confidential data.'
- Correlative conjunctions: 'Hardly had he entered... when the lights went out' / 'No sooner did she finish... than they clapped.'
- Redundancy: Avoid 'Despite of' (correct: 'Despite' or 'In spite of'); avoid 'more smarter' (correct: 'smarter').
- Parallelism: Elements in a series must share grammatical form (e.g. 'She likes reading, writing, and painting').

PLACEMENT PREPARATIO

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Voices, Speeches & Idiomatic Expressions

3. Active & Passive Voice Transformation

- Simple Present: Active 'She writes a letter' -> Passive 'A letter is written by her.'
- Past Continuous: Active 'The students were decorating the room' -> Passive 'The room was being decorated by the students.'
- Modals: Active 'We must follow the rules' -> Passive 'The rules must be followed.'
- Future Perfect: Active 'They will have finished the work' -> Passive 'The work will have been finished by them.'

4. Common Placement Idioms & Phrases

- 'Break the ice': Initiate friendly conversation in an awkward situation.
- 'Burn the midnight oil': Study or work late into the night.
- 'Hit the nail on the head': State or diagnose something with exact precision.
- 'Blessing in disguise': A misfortune that eventually results in an unexpected positive outcome.
- 'Face the music': Accept unpleasant consequences of one's actions.